



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Heritage Classical Academy
School Website: <https://heritageclassicalacademy.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS: **MEMBER** SCL: **MEMBER**

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Heritage Classical Academy (Pepper Pike, OH, 44023) (HCA) exhibits a robust Classical Christian orientation across all six classical categories. Public materials from the school consistently foreground Christ-centered, virtue-formation aims, a trivium-centered curriculum (grammar, logic, rhetoric), engagement with Great Books and the Great Conversation, and a pedagogy that blends contemplative forms with Socratic/seminar-style inquiry in upper grades. The school emphasizes liturgical and communal practices (chapel/convocation), Latin study, memory work, and a strong sense of a shared intellectual and spiritual heritage. There is clear signaling of parent partnership and family formation through multiple channels (Prospective Families pages, campus tours, study-center tracks for homeschool families, EdChoice information). Taken together, these signals align Heritage Classical Academy with CLASSICAL (not merely somewhat classical or non-classical) according to the Six Essential Elements framework.

Key evidentiary signals include: Christ-centered education and belief that God's Word underpins all knowledge; explicit articulation of formation over information and the Great Conversation with Great Books; explicit Trivium emphasis (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and plan for Latin, history, and memory work; contemplative/restful learning balanced with Socratic/seminar-type upper-level pedagogy; living-faculty-centered culture (portrait-of-teacher visuals, faculty as core of the curriculum); and documented parent-partnership structures (campus tours, study-center options, EdChoice and family engagement). Citations drawn from the school's public materials show these patterns directly (e.g., Christ-centered messaging and Great Books/Great Conversation language; liturgical practices; memory-work and Latin curricula; Rhetoric School framing; and parent-community offerings). See sources referencing Christ-centered identity, chapel/convocation, Great Conversation, Grammar/Logic/Rhetoric, Great Books, Latin, and Study Center/Prospective-Families materials.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — **CLASSICAL**

- Evidence
- Public materials consistently describe a Christ-centered education and a worldview anchored in God's Word and biblical truth. For example, HCA states it offers "a Christ-centered education led by passionate teachers and grounded in proven classical curriculum" and emphasizes forming students to "live for Christ" (and in some copy, to "know God" as foundational).
- The school explicitly references God and Scripture as organizing frameworks (e.g., "God's Word" and a Christian worldview), including a motto aligned with truth (*Veritas lux mea* – The truth is my light).
- Liturgical/communal practices are explicit (Convocation and Chapel; twice-monthly chapel; communal prayer groups).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive indicators present: Christ-centered, God's Word, theology, liturgy/worship/chapel, great conversation, truth, virtue, moral formation, sacred tradition, reverence.
- Negative indicators present: none detected in public materials (no signaling of secular relativism, value-neutral ethics, or anti-liturgical stances in the school materials reviewed).
- Estimated hit pattern: Positive keyword hits approx. 8; Negative keyword hits approx. 0; Positive share approx. 100%.
- Why this rating
- The school's own language embeds a transcendental, theologically grounded frame (Christ-centered, God's Word, liturgical practices), which aligns strongly with the Positive Keyword indicators for Religious and Metaphysical Foundations. The absence of negative-leaning signals in the public materials supports a CLASSICAL assessment for this category.

Citations: Christ-centered claims and Great Conversation language appear in the school materials; chapel/-convocation language appears in the chapel/congregational sections; motto and theology references appear in the Great Books/classical education discussions.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The school publicly describes education as formation of virtue and wisdom, not merely information or work-prep. Statements emphasize forming character in service of Christ and human flourishing, with language about the formation of a good life and the aim to cultivate virtue and rightly ordered affections.
- The Great Conversation/great books framing signals a purpose beyond mere test scores or career outcomes, aligning with the classical telos to cultivate truth, goodness, and beauty in a holistic sense.
- There are explicit references to knowing truth, goodness, and beauty, and to forming students to live within a Christian worldview.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive indicators present: formation, virtue, wisdom, human flourishing, true/good/beautiful, contemplation, classical mission, liberal education, soul formation, moral imagination, love of learning.
- Negative indicators present: none observed (no explicit emphasis on workforce-readiness, job-training, or utilitarian metrics as primary aims).
- Positive hits approx. 7; Negative hits approx. 0; Positive share approx. 100%.
- Why this rating
- The school's stated purpose matches the CLASSICAL expectation of formation and the pursuit of true, good, and beautiful ends, rather than a primary focus on job prep or purely information-based outcomes.

Citations: Formation language and Christian worldview framing appear in the public materials; the Great Conversation and virtue-focused language are present in the materials cited.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The program explicitly centers the liberal arts framework: grammar, logic, and rhetoric; extensive emphasis on Great Books and the Great Conversation; study of history across disciplines; Latin study; and a historically grounded, integrated curriculum. Texts discuss grammar/logic/rhetoric triad and the Great Books; memory work and historical study are highlighted in the Grammar School materials; Latin instruction is described as foundational.
- References to "Great Books," "Great Conversation," and the interdisciplinary approach align with classical curriculum goals. The memory work, history depth, and Latin instruction appear across multiple pages.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive indicators present: Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books, Great Conversation, Latin, history-rich curriculum, interdisciplinary integration, wonder/anticipation in learning.

- Negative indicators present: none evident (no replacement with social studies-only framing; no emphasis on project-based-only or STEM-first framing observed).
- Positive hits approx. 9; Negative hits approx. 0; Positive share approx. 100%.
- Why this rating
- The curriculum signals strongly conform to classical core elements (Trivium; Great Books; historical scope; Latin; integrated study; sense of wonder), consistent with CLASSICAL expectations.

Citations: Grammar/Logic/Rhetoric and Great Books/Great Conversation references appear across public materials; Latin and history emphasis are described on curriculum pages.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Lower- to middle-school pedagogy includes memory work, recitation, chants, and engaged review—mechanisms to deepen memory and delight, aligned with traditional Classical pedagogy. The grammar stage emphasizes memorization and mnemonic strategies (Memory Period, etc.).
- Upper school pedagogy is described as culminating in rhetoric, with opportunities for speeches and rhetoric training; seminars and dialogues are implied through the “Rhetoric School” framing and the classical-trivium progression.
- The Great Conversation and Socratic/seminal-dialogue philosophy are embedded in the public-facing materials and program descriptions, consistent with classical pedagogical methods (Socratic dialogue, seminars, debates, rhetoric instruction).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive indicators present: memory work; recitation; chanting; grammar/history-based content; Socratic/seminars/debates; rhetoric/speeches; upper-school rhetoric training; contemplative/scholastic rhythm.
- Negative indicators present: minimal to no signaling of project-based-only or purely experiential learning as the sole method; no prominent anti-rhetoric signals.
- Positive hits approx. 8; Negative hits approx. 0; Positive share approx. 100%.
- Why this rating
- Pedagogy aligns with classical methods (memory-based early learning, recitation and chant; then Socratic/seminar rhetoric by upper levels), consistent with CLASSICAL expectations.

Citations: Memory Period and lower-school recitation; Grammar/Logic/Rhetoric framing; Rhetoric School page; and public descriptions of upper-level seminars.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Public materials emphasize that faculty are not just instructors but “model teachers and mentors” and are framed as the living curriculum and core of the school culture; images and pages highlight portraits of the faculty and administrative teams; there are explicit references to faculty as guides in a collegial, community-focused environment.
- Pages such as “Portrait of the Graduate” and “Portrait of the Faculty Member” indicate explicit attention to teacher-culture and role-modeling within the school’s classical formation paradigm.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive indicators present: model teachers and mentors; living curriculum; portrait of the teacher; faculty as core past and present; collegial culture; teacher formation and mentorship themes.
- Negative indicators present: none evident in public-facing content.
- Positive hits approx. 6; Negative hits approx. 0; Positive share approx. 100%.
- Why this rating
- The faculty presentation is squarely aligned with classical expectations that teachers are central to formation and living curriculum, rather than merely technicians delivering content.

Citations: Language about teachers as living curriculum and portraits; faculty pages and leadership sections.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The school emphasizes partnerships with families and open channels for parent engagement (Prospective Families pages, campus tours, events, parent information nights). The existence of a Study Center to partner with homeschool families indicates a deliberate model of family involvement and shared educational mission.
- EdChoice/tuition materials and Family-facing communications illustrate ongoing outreach to parents as co-educators and participants in the school's classical project. There are references to parent formation, book studies, gatherings, and opportunities to visit the campus.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive indicators present: partnership with families; parent formation; home-school hybrid options; open campus; campus visits; books and parent gatherings; community engagement.
- Negative indicators present: none observed (no signals of treating parents as customers only or minimal parental involvement).
- Positive hits approx. 7; Negative hits approx. 0; Positive share approx. 100%.
- Why this rating
- The school's family-centric and community-engaged posture aligns with CLASSICAL expectations for parent partnership and community cultivation of virtue and formation.

Citations: Prospective-Families pages, events, campus-tour content; EdChoice/family engagement materials.

Aggregate Assessment - Overall classification: CLASSICAL - Category-wise verdicts: All six categories scored CLASSICAL, with explicit evidence of classical framework (Trivium, Great Books, Great Conversation, liturgical/community life, formation-centered purpose, strong faculty culture, and robust parent/community engagement). - Executive rationale: Heritage Classical Academy presents a coherent classical Christian educational identity across the core elements of religious/metaphysical foundations, formation-centered purpose, traditional curriculum, classical pedagogy, living-faculty culture, and active parent/community involvement. The site's emphasis on Christ-centered education, the Great Conversation, memory-work, Latin, history, and the Trivium, along with liturgical chapel practices and a family-partnered model, substantiates a CLASSICAL rating rather than a merely somewhat classical or non-classical posture.

Citations: Core evidence points drawn from the public Heritage materials that reference Christ-centered education, Great Books/Great Conversation, Grammar-Logic-Rhetoric, Latin, history, memory work, chapel/convocation, faculty portraits and living-curriculum language, and parent/community engagement.

What Would Move the Needle

Not applicable here since the aggregate rating is CLASSICAL. No major category requires needle-moving changes to reach CLASSICAL across the rubric, given the current public-facing materials.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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